



◀ METALWORK

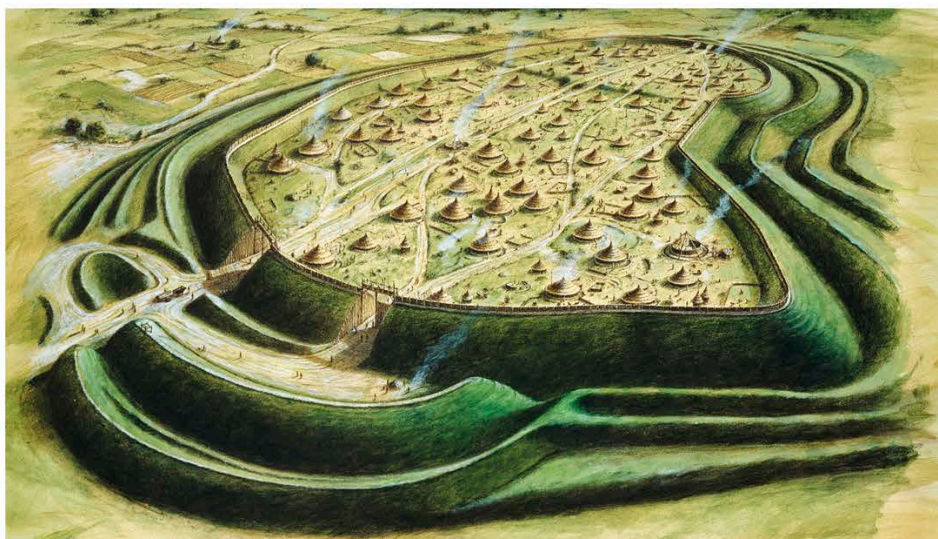
Celts were expert metalworkers, decorating bronze artifacts, such as shields and the backs of mirrors, with elaborate patterns. Many bronze items have been found in rivers and lakes, where they were thrown as offerings to gods. This shield was found in the Thames River, near Battersea, London, UK.

Red glass studs inlaid on the bronze Battersea Shield

BOUDICCA



Following the Roman conquest of southern Britain, Queen Boudicca of the Iceni, a Celtic tribe in eastern England, led a great uprising against the invaders. In 61 BCE, her army sacked three Roman towns before being defeated.



▲ HILLFORTS

In Britain, Celtic tribes built great hillforts, which were defended by deep ditches and tall earth banks topped by timber walls. Maiden Castle (above) in southern England is one such example. It was home to hundreds of people who lived in thatched wooden roundhouses.

▼ RELIGION

The Celts worshipped hundreds of gods and offered them precious objects and sacrifices. Each clan had its own deities, but some gods were followed over a wider area under different names. One of them was the nature god, who the Gauls called Cernunnos.



The nature god is surrounded by wild animals.



◀ COINS

After coming into contact with the Romans and the Greeks through trade, the Celts initially copied their coins. This Celtic gold coin, featuring a horse, was inspired by one issued by King Philip of Macedonia. Later, the Celts developed their own style, designing coins featuring images of deities and local chiefs.

450 BCE

A second Celtic culture, called La Tène, spreads from present-day Switzerland across much of Europe, stretching from Spain to Romania. Its metalwork has swirling patterns.

400–390 BCE

The Celtic Senones tribe invades what is now Italy, sacking Rome in 390 BCE. The Romans pay them a huge sum in gold to leave.

279–278 BCE

A massive Celtic army invades Greece but is eventually turned back. Part of the army moves into Anatolia, in modern-day Turkey, settling the area of Galatia.

58–51 BCE

The Celts' dominance across northern Europe comes to an end when Roman general Julius Caesar conquers Gaul and part of Britain.